Telecommunications

20% | Global 22%	40% | Global 39%	85% | Global 83%	89% | Global 88%
Labour-market churn	**Skill disruption**	**Organizations with DEI priorities**	**AI exposure**
Five-year structural labour-force churn	Shares of core skills which will change	Share of organizations with DEI priorities	Share of organizations running AI programmes

Trend outlook

Macrotrends driving business transformation

Share of organizations surveyed that identified this trend as likely to drive transformation in their organization

Industry | Global

	Industry	Global
Broadening digital access	81%	60%
Rising cost of living, higher prices or inflation	46%	50%
Increased efforts and investments to reduce carbon…	41%	47%
Slower economic growth	41%	42%
Increased focus on labour and social issues	35%	46%
Increased efforts and investments to adapt to climate…	32%	41%
Increased geopolitical division and conflicts	32%	34%
Growing working-age populations	30%	24%
Stricter anti-trust and competition regulations	24%	17%
Ageing and declining working-age populations	24%	40%
Increased government subsidies and industrial policy	16%	21%
Increased restrictions to global trade and investment	14%	23%

Technology trends

Technology trends driving business transformation

Share of organizations surveyed that identify the technology trend as likely to drive business transformation

Industry | Global

	Industry	Global
AI and information processing technologies (big data, VR, AR…	100%	86%
Robots and autonomous systems	58%	58%
Satellites and space technologies	40%	9%
Energy generation, storage and distribution	34%	41%
Semiconductors and computing technologies	34%	20%
Quantum and encryption	29%	12%
New materials and composites	16%	30%
Sensing, laser and optical technologies	16%	18%
Biotechnology and gene technologies	5%	11%

Jobs outlook

Key roles for business transformation

Roles most selected by organizations surveyed, ordered by net role growth, and their net growth and structural churn (percent)

Net growth | Job Growth | Job displacement | Net Growth | Global net growth

1. Net growth 2. Global net growth 3. Churn

NET GROWTH -100% 0 100%

	1.	2.	3.
AI and Machine Learning Specialists	65	82	65
Data Analysts and Scientists	52	41	52
Data Engineers	35	36	35
Managing Directors and Chief Executives	13	5	13
Accounting, Bookkeeping and Payroll Clerks	-17	-18	27
Administrative Assistants and Executive Secretaries	-24	-20	24

Skill outlook

Skills of increasing use by 2030

Skills of the most increase in use by 2030

Industry | Global

CORE SKILLS OF 2025		SKILLS OF INCREASING USE BY 2030	
Analytical thinking	86%	AI and big data	100%
Leadership and social influence	76%	Resilience, flexibility and agility	79%
Creative thinking	66%	Curiosity and lifelong learning	75%
Resilience, flexibility and agility	66%	Networks and cybersecurity	75%
AI and big data	66%	Creative thinking	75%

Workforce Strategy outlook

Key components of your workforce strategy by 2030

% surveyed organizations selecting the macrotrend to drive workforce transformation

Industry | Global

	INDUSTRY	GLOBAL
Upskill your workforce	96%	85%
Accelerate the automation of processes and tasks	82%	73%
Hire staff with new skills to meet emerging business needs	70%	70%

Upskilling and reskilling outlook

37 | Global 41	29 | Global 29	24 | Global 19	11 | Global 11
Would not need training by 2030	Would be upskilled in their current role	Would be upskilled and redeployed	Would be unlikely to upskill

Telecommunications

Human-machine frontier

Human-machine frontier

% of tasks completed by predominantly people, predominantly technology, or a combination of both

Human | Global | Combination | Global | Technology | Global

ALL TASKS

	Human	Combination	Technology
Now	40%	33%	27%
Now (Global)	48%	30%	22%
2030	28%	33%	39%
2030 (Global)	33%	33%	34%

Business Practice

Business practices to improve talent availability

Top practices with the greatest potential to improve talent availability (share of organizations surveyed)

Industry | Global

	INDUSTRY	GLOBAL
Providing effective reskilling and upskilling	67%	63%
Improving talent progression and promotion processes	63%	62%
Offering remote and hybrid work opportunities within countries	59%	43%
Supporting employee health and well-being	56%	64%
Offering higher wages	52%	50%

Key barriers for business transformation

Transformation barriers

Share of organisations surveyed expecting the barriers will hinder their organisation transformation

Industry | Global

	INDUSTRY	GLOBAL
Skills gaps in the labour market	66%	63%
Outdated or inflexible regulatory framework	42%	39%
Organization culture and resistance to change	40%	46%
Lack of adequate data and technical infrastructure	29%	32%
Inability to attract talent to the industry	24%	37%

Wage outlook

Wage trends

Share of organizations projecting the share of wages and other forms of workers' compensation as percentage of the company's total revenues

Growing | Global | Similar | Global | Declining | Global

	Growing	Similar	Declining
	41%	52%	7%
Global	8%	52%	41%

Talent availability outlook

Talent trend

Share of respondents who expect their talent availability to improve or worsen in five years

Improving | Global average | Worsening | Global average

	Improving	Worsening
Talent availability when hiring	48%	40%
Talent development of existing workforce	36%	8%
Talent retention of existing workforce	40%	24%

DEI Actions

Share of employers surveyed planning to implement the diversity, equity and inclusion measure

	Global	
67	51	Run comprehensive DEI training for managers and staff
52	48	Targeted recruitment, retention and progression initiatives
48	42	Set DEI goals, targets or quotas

AI Strategy

Share of employers surveyed planning to implement the stated strategy in response to AI's increasing capability and prevalence

	Global	
89	69	Hiring new people with skills to design AI tools and enhancements appropriate for the organization-specific skills
74	77	Reskilling and upskilling your existing workforce to better work alongside AI
67	62	Hiring new people with skills to better work alongside AI